

The Tumbleweed repository is built on top of the 11.4 repositories. Only the packages that have changed are present in it. Over time, as more packages deviate from the 11.4 version, they will get incorporated into Tumbleweed. We will have to wait and watch what happens when 11.5 is released; would all the packages be incorporated in Tumbleweed, or would you need to replace the 11.4 repositories with those for 11.5?

Supporting a rolling distribution and stable releases, approximately twice a year, adds to the complexity from the perspective of both developers and users. Hopefully, Tumbleweed will dominate and win!

The problem with packages being in multiple repositories also introduces the problem of which ones to search for updates. OpenSUSE follows a policy of not permitting 'vendor' change, by default, while installing updates. Each repository has a vendor code associated with it. The possibilities and options are described in http://en.opensuse.org/SDB:Vendor_change_update. In your case, the vendor code for Tumbleweed is different from that of the OpenSUSE official repositories. This means that `sudo zypper update` will not update packages that have been newly added to Tumbleweed. You need to again run `sudo zypper dup --from Tumbleweed`. A solution was suggested on the mailing list, like the one used by the Evergreen project to extend the life of OpenSUSE 11.1—<http://en.opensuse.org/Evergreen>. Create a

file `/etc/zypp/vendors.d/tumbleweed` with the following content:

```
[main]
vendors = obs://build.opensuse.org/openSUSE:Tumbleweed,suse,opensuse
```

Here, `obs://build.opensuse.org/openSUSE:Tumbleweed` is the vendor code of the Tumbleweed repository. The list of vendors ensures that the specified vendors are treated as one common group. Hence, any new additions to the Tumbleweed repository will now be updated without any special effort on your part.

So far, using OpenSUSE Tumbleweed has worked well for me. The KDE environment is consistent across Arch Linux, Fedora and OpenSUSE, which I have used on the Lenovo Netbook. The one disappointment has been that while OpenSUSE's Updates repository distributes delta RPM packages, the Tumbleweed repository does not. The frequent updates of LibreOffice packages does create a barrier to daily updates. I am hoping that the developers will add delta RPMs to the Tumbleweed repository as well—but, unfortunately, bandwidth issues are not a significant concern in the developed world.

The benefits of Tumbleweed will be clearer as one uses it for at least a year. I expect it to be similar to the Arch Linux experience. Hence, the Canterbury Distribution (http://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/The_Canterbury_Distribution), which was the April Fool joke this year, may indeed be the one true answer! 

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